

Cognizant Training and Learning Development Guide

****Effective Date:** January 1, 2026**

1. Overview

Cognizant is heavily invested in the continuous learning and professional development of its associates. We believe that learning is a lifelong journey and a key driver of personal growth and business success. Our learning culture empowers employees to acquire new skills, stay abreast of emerging technologies, and build fulfilling careers. Through a comprehensive ecosystem of platforms, programs, and partnerships, Cognizant ensures that every employee has the tools and resources necessary to thrive in a rapidly changing digital landscape.

2. Cognizant Academy

****Cognizant Academy**** is the central learning management system and primary platform for all training needs within the organization.

- ****Course Catalog:**** The academy hosts a vast catalog of over 10,000+ courses.
- ****Categories:**** Courses cover a wide spectrum of areas including cutting-edge technology (AI, Cloud, Data), domain-specific knowledge (Healthcare, BFSI), soft skills (communication, presentation), and leadership programs.
- ****Accessibility:**** The platform is accessible via the web portal and a dedicated mobile app, allowing associates to learn on the go.

3. GenC Training Program (Freshers)

The GenC (Generation Cognizant) program is an intensive 8-12 week foundational training program designed for campus recruits and fresh graduates.

- ****Technology Streams:**** Trainees are mapped to specific streams based on business demand, including Full Stack Java, Full Stack .NET, Data Engineering, Testing/QA, and Cloud & DevOps.
- ****Daily Schedule:**** The program demands a rigorous 9 AM to 6 PM schedule.
- ****Methodology:**** The curriculum blends classroom instruction (virtual or physical) with extensive hands-on labs and mentor-guided projects.

- ****Assessments:**** Continuous evaluation is a hallmark of the program, with assessments conducted every week. A minimum score of 60% is required to pass the program.
- ****Advanced Tracks:**** Top-performing candidates may be selected for GenC Pro (advanced track) or GenC Next (highly specialized technology tracks).

4. Mandatory Training Modules

All Cognizant associates are required to complete several mandatory compliance training modules annually.

- ****Modules Include:**** Information Security Awareness, Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH), Anti-Bribery & Anti-Corruption, Data Privacy (GDPR/CCPA), and the Code of Ethics.
- ****Deadlines:**** These modules are typically assigned with a 30-day completion window.
- ****Consequences:**** Non-completion of these mandatory modules by the specified deadlines will result in escalations to the reporting manager, impact on the annual performance appraisal, and potential restriction of system access.

5. Certification Programs

Cognizant strongly encourages and supports associates in obtaining industry-recognized certifications.

- ****Sponsored Certifications:**** Popular sponsored certifications include AWS (Solutions Architect, Developer), Azure (AZ-900, AZ-204, AZ-400), Google Cloud (Associate Cloud Engineer), Salesforce, ServiceNow, and SAP.
- ****Reimbursement Policy:**** Cognizant reimburses 100% of the examination fee for the first attempt upon successful passing of the certification.
- ****Incentives:**** In addition to reimbursement, successful completion of specific high-demand certifications may attract certification bonus incentives as announced by the business units.

6. Skill Development Programs

To ensure our workforce is future-ready, Cognizant Academy offers targeted skill development programs.

- **Digital Skill Tracks:** Comprehensive learning journeys in high-demand areas like AI/ML, Cloud Native, IoT, Blockchain, and Cybersecurity.
- **Upskilling:** Programs designed to help associates transition their careers into new technology domains.
- **Skill Gap Analysis:** An integrated tool within Cognizant Academy helps associates identify their current proficiency levels against target roles and recommends personalized learning paths to bridge the gaps.

7. Leadership Development

We cultivate leadership at all levels through structured programs.

- **Managers:** The 'Cognizant Elevate' program is tailored for new and mid-level managers to build team leadership and delivery excellence skills.
- **Senior Leadership:** The Senior Leadership Academy focuses on strategic thinking, business acumen, and organizational leadership.
- **Other Initiatives:** We also offer executive coaching and 'Management Essentials' training for emerging leaders.

8. External Learning Support

Cognizant partners with leading external providers to augment internal learning resources.

- **Platform Access:** Associates are provided access to premium platforms like LinkedIn Learning and specialized courses via Coursera and Udemy partnerships.
- **Higher Education:** The Higher Education Assistance program provides sponsorship criteria for pursuing MBA/MS degrees from recognized universities, subject to tenure and performance conditions.
- **Conferences:** The conference attendance policy supports associates in attending relevant industry conferences and seminars, requiring manager and BU head approval.

9. Learning Hours Requirement

Continuous learning is embedded in our performance metrics.

- ****Requirement:**** Every associate is expected to complete a minimum of 40 learning hours per calendar year.
- ****Tracking:**** These hours are tracked automatically via the Cognizant Academy dashboard.
- ****Impact:**** Fulfilling this learning hours requirement is a prerequisite and directly impacts the annual performance appraisal process and ratings.

10. Knowledge Sharing

Peer-to-peer learning is a vital component of the Cognizant culture.

- ****Activities:**** Associates are encouraged to participate in internal tech talks, brown bag sessions, and community of practice groups.
- ****Hackathons:**** The annual Cognizant Hackathon invites teams globally to solve complex business problems using innovative technology solutions.
- ****Publishing:**** Associates can contribute by publishing technical articles and thought leadership pieces on the internal Cognizant blog.

11. How to Access Training

- ****Portal Access:**** Navigate to the 'Cognizant Academy' tile on the iConnect homepage or app.
- ****Enrollment:**** Browse or search the catalog, select the desired course, and click 'Enroll'. Some specialized courses may require manager approval before enrollment is confirmed.
- ****Certification Requests:**** To request a certification voucher or reimbursement, raise a ticket through the ****OneITSM**** portal under the 'Learning & Development' - > 'Certifications' category. This request will route to your manager for approval.

12. FAQs (Frequently Asked Questions)

****Q1: How do I access Cognizant Academy from outside the network?****

A1: You can access Cognizant Academy via the mobile app using PingID authentication, or via the web if you are connected to the Cognizant VPN.

****Q2: What happens if I fail an assessment during the GenC training program?****

A2: Trainees who fail an assessment are typically given one opportunity to retake it. Consistent failure to meet the 60% minimum score may lead to release from the program and the company.

****Q3: Are the 40 learning hours mandatory for all roles?****

A3: Yes, the minimum 40 learning hours requirement is a global mandate applicable to all associates across all roles and business units.

****Q4: How do I claim reimbursement for an external certification?****

A4: After passing the exam, raise a request on OneITSM, attach the passing certificate and the fee receipt. Upon manager approval, the amount will be credited with your next payroll cycle.

****Q5: Will Cognizant reimburse a certification exam if I fail the first attempt?****

A5: No, the reimbursement policy covers 100% of the exam fee only upon a successful pass on the first attempt. Subsequent attempts must be self-funded.

****Q6: Can I take courses that are unrelated to my current project?****

A6: Yes, Cognizant encourages cross-skilling. You can take any course in Cognizant Academy. However, for paid external courses or certifications, alignment with your career path and manager approval is required.

****Q7: How do I check my completed learning hours?****

A7: You can view your completed learning hours and course history on your personal dashboard within the Cognizant Academy portal.

****Q8: Are the mandatory compliance training modules part of the 40 learning hours?****

A8: Yes, the hours spent completing the mandatory compliance modules are counted towards your annual 40-hour learning requirement.